General rule – attunement and magic items · "Magic Items" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

Some magic items require **attunement** to function. You attune to an item by touching it during a **Short Rest** (at least 1 hour) while focusing on it. You can be attuned to only **3 items** at a time.

Attunement ends if you move more than **100 ft** from the item for 24 hours, if you die, if another creature attunes, or if you choose to end it during a Short Rest.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Attunement: **1 hour** Short Rest, touching the item.
2. Maximum **3 attuned items**.
3. The item's prerequisites must be met (class, etc.).
4. Ends at 100 ft for 24 h, on death, or by choice.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the three-item limit and clarifies attunement needs a Short Rest and contact.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text leaves attunement to cursed items open. Fix: the DM announces consequences before play.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the bond (a tingle, warmth) that marks attunement.

Step 1 – Check the item:

Does it require attunement? What conditions (class, alignment)?

Step 2 – Touch and focus:

During a Short Rest (1 hour), you touch the item.

Step 3 – Count:

You can have only 3 attuned items; break one for a 4th.

Step 4 – Use:

Many items activate with the Magic action; some need a command word.

Step 5 – End:

Ends at 100 ft for 24 h, on death, or by choosing to end it during a Short Rest.

Example: Elora attunes to a wand (1 h Short Rest): she now has 1 attuned item out of 3.

Element	Rule
Attunement	1 h Short Rest, touching the item
Limit	3 attuned items
Prerequisites	Class, species, alignment: must be met to attune
End	100 ft for 24 h, death, ending at a Short Rest
Rarities	Common, Uncommon, Rare, Very Rare, Legendary, Artifact
Activation	Magic action, command word or use
Charges	Usually recharge at dawn

⚠ Common questions:

Do all magic items need attunement?

No: only those that say so.

How many items?

Three maximum.

Can I attune in combat?

No: a Short Rest is needed.

What if I move away?

Ends at 100 ft for 24 hours.

Can I end it at will?

Yes, during a Short Rest.

A shared item?

Only one attuned person at a time.

Charges?

They return at dawn depending on the item.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Fourth item

Can I exceed three? **Option**: no (SRD rule).

Cursed items

Attuning to a cursed item: **Option**: can't remove it without a spell.

During sleep

Does attunement count as a Long Rest? **Option**: no.

Familiar items

Can a familiar attune? **Option**: no.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Short Rest

Attunement requires focusing on the item throughout the rest.

Prerequisites

If prerequisites are no longer met, attunement ends.

Rarity

Rarity indicates power; it doesn't decide attunement.

Activation

Many items activate with the Magic action.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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